Brindlewave Employee Handbook

Version 3.1 — effective 1 July 2025. Owner: People Team (Priya Raman, Head of People).

This handbook applies to all permanent employees of Brindlewave B.V. and its subsidiaries in the United States and Singapore. Where local law grants more generous terms, local law applies. Policy changes announced by the People Team in writing supersede the corresponding section of this handbook until the next version is published.

1. Working hours

Brindlewave uses flexible working hours. All employees are expected to be available during core hours, 10:00 to 15:00 in their office's local time, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours, you may organise your working day as you see fit, provided your team's commitments are met. A full-time contract is 40 hours per week in the United States and Singapore and 38 hours per week in the Netherlands.

2. Paid time off (PTO)

Full-time employees receive 25 days of paid time off per calendar year, in addition to the public holidays of the country where their office is located. Part-time employees receive PTO pro-rated to their contracted hours. Employees who join or leave mid-year receive PTO pro-rated to the months worked.

PTO must be requested in the HR system (Ledgerly People) at least 10 working days in advance for absences of 5 or more consecutive days, and at least 2 working days in advance for shorter absences.

Carryover. Up to 5 unused PTO days may be carried over into the following calendar year. Carried-over days must be used by 31 March of that year; any carried-over days not used by then expire. Unused days beyond the carryover limit are not paid out, except where required by local law on termination.

3. Sick leave

Brindlewave does not set a fixed cap on sick days. Notify your manager as early as possible on the first day of absence. A doctor's note is required after 3 consecutive sick days. Long-term illness (more than 4 consecutive weeks) is handled with the People Team and, in the Netherlands, the company occupational health service.

4. Parental leave

Employees become eligible for parental leave after 6 months of continuous employment.

- Primary caregivers receive 20 weeks of fully paid parental leave.
- Secondary caregivers receive 6 weeks of fully paid parental leave.

Parental leave can be taken in one block or split into up to three blocks within 12 months of the birth or adoption. Statutory leave schemes apply in addition where they are more generous.

5. Remote and hybrid work

Employees who live within 50 km of a Brindlewave office work in a hybrid model and are expected in the office at least 2 days per week. Team-specific office days are set by each department head. Employees living further than 50 km from an office may work fully remotely with written approval from their department head.

Every employee receives a one-time home office stipend of €750 (or the USD or SGD equivalent at the payroll exchange rate) and a monthly internet allowance of €40. Receipts for the home office stipend must be submitted within 90 days of your start date.

6. Learning and development

Every employee has an annual learning budget of €1,500 for courses, books, certifications and conference attendance, including conference travel. The budget resets on 1 January and unused budget does not roll over. Requests above €500 require manager approval before booking.

7. Expenses and travel

Expense claims must be submitted in Ledgerly within 30 days of the expense, with a receipt for every item above €25.

Approval thresholds.

- Up to €500: approved by your manager.
- €500 to €5,000: approved by your department head.
- Above €5,000: approved by the VP Finance (Marcus Lindqvist).

Travel. Book flights and hotels through the travel desk. Economy class is standard for flights shorter than 6 hours; premium economy is allowed for flights of 6 hours or longer. Business class requires VP Finance approval. The daily meal allowance while travelling is €70 for domestic trips and €90 for international trips. Hotel rates should not exceed €180 per night in Europe and $250 per night in the United States unless pre-approved.

8. Equipment

New employees choose a MacBook Pro or a Lenovo ThinkPad X1 Carbon. Laptops are refreshed every 3 years, or earlier if the device fails. Equipment remains company property and must be returned within 10 working days of leaving the company. Lost or stolen devices must be reported to security@brindlewave.example within 24 hours.

9. Probation and notice periods

The probation period is 2 months in the Netherlands and 90 days in the United States and Singapore. The notice period is 1 month during probation and 2 months after probation, for both employee and employer, unless the employment contract states otherwise.

10. Code of conduct

We expect every employee to treat colleagues, customers and partners with respect. Harassment and discrimination of any kind are not tolerated. Concerns can be raised with your manager, the People Team, or anonymously via ethics@brindlewave.example. Reports are reviewed by the Head of People and the General Counsel within 5 working days, and retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith is itself a violation of this code.